

Consumers to spend \$1 trillion on electronics in 2012

The Consumer Electronics Association (CEA) of USA expects the global spending on electronics to slow down this year but still cross the \$1 trillion mark.

CEA expects smartphones to drive the industry sales this year, as these did last year. The association also expects tablet computers to help boost global sales. The purchases in emerging markets like India, China and Brazil should also contribute to the industry sales this year.

Smartphone and tablet sales, however, will slow down—not because of the slowdown in demand but as against their fast growth last year.

Fewer TV purchases this year

According to an Accenture survey, consumers intend to buy fewer televisions this year and fewer are regularly watching content on them.

The survey highlighted that consumers are rapidly turning to other consumer electronics devices such as smartphones and tablet computers to view media, while also using more online services and downloading applications for various purposes, including entertainment.

The survey found that the number of consumers watching broadcast or cable TV in a typical week on televisions fell from 71 per cent in 2009 to 48 per cent in 2011. Consistent with this, the percentage of consumers who intend to buy a TV set during the next year declined from 35 per cent in 2010 to 32 per cent in 2011.

Solar sector report card

After monitoring the solar sector funding and merger and acquisition (M&A) transactions for 2011, Mercom Capital Group has announced the fourth-quarter and annual report for solar. According to the report, India

Samsung appoints regional president and CEO south-west Asia operations

Samsung has appointed B.D. Park as regional president and CEO of Samsung south west Asia operations and managing director of Samsung India Electronics. Prior to this, Park was head of mobile and IT division at Samsung India as director, mobile and IT.

In the new role, Park will oversee the operations of Samsung India Electronics Pvt Ltd (SIEL), Samsung India Software Operations (SISO), Samsung's R&D centre at Bengaluru, Samsung India Software Center (SISC) and SEL India, Samsung's R&D centres at Noida as well as the company's operations in the SAARC region.

Micromax strengthens its core team

As part of strengthening its management team in India, Micromax has appointed Deepak Mehrotra as the CEO. Also, Khaja Muzaffarullah from Sony Ericsson has joined as the feature phone division head and Ajay Sharma, ex-country head from HTC, will lead the smartphone division.

Thompson is Yahoo's new CEO

Yahoo has appointed Scott Thompson, former president of PayPal, as its new chief executive officer. Thompson will replace Tim Morse, the interim chief executive of the company. He will also join the company's board.

Morse, who was previously the chief financial officer of the company, was made the interim chief executive after the firing of Carol Bartz in September

received \$95 million in venture capital (VC) funding and over \$1.1 billion in large-scale project funding in 2011.

Among Indian companies, solar project developer Kiran Energy raised \$30 million in Series A funding and \$50 million in Series B funding, followed by Birla Surya with \$15 million. The top large-scale project funding deal in India was the \$694-million loan raised

2010. Morse will now return to his previous role.

AMD appoints SVP and chief strategy officer

Rajan Naik has joined AMD as senior vice president and chief strategy officer. He will report to president and chief executive officer Rory Read. Naik will be responsible for AMD's short- and long-term strategy development, including market opportunities, strategic partnerships and investment strategies.

Altair appoints VP, India services

Altair Engineering has appointed Panduranga Rao Chirala as vice president of Altair ProductDesign India. In this new role, Chirala will have primary responsibility for Altair's consulting services operations in India and support the company's global product development consultancy business with off-shore capacity. He will be responsible for managing and growing the India-based engineering service team for product design.

Axis Communications appoints country manager

Axis Communications has appointed Sudhindra Holla as the new country manager for its Indian operations. Holla will lead Axis Communications' operations in India, driving business strategy in addition to overlooking sales and marketing verticals. Since 100 per cent of the company's revenues come from channels, he will place emphasis on channel development to expand the reach of Axis' products and services in the country.

by Maharashtra State Power Generation Company for its 150-megawatt Dhule project (\$338 million) and 125-megawatt Sakri project (\$356 million) solar power plants by KfW Group.

Indian job market to boom this year

In stark contrast to the fears of economic slowdown hurting the country,

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